

MacroLens Daily Brief — August 11, 2026

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Top Headlines

1. Oil continues climb with doubts about potential US-Iran deal; stocks retreat -

Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-11 19:06

Oil prices rose amid doubts over a potential US-Iran deal, while global stocks retreated on geopolitical uncertainty.

2. Trump says Iran options are let Tehran fail economically or 'hit them really hard' -

Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-11 16:04

President Trump stated US options on Iran are limited to economic collapse or military action, escalating geopolitical risk.

3. Hormuz to stay closed unless US meets Iran's conditions, Iran official says -

Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-11 17:45

An Iranian official said the Strait of Hormuz will remain closed unless US meets Iran's conditions, threatening oil supply routes.

4. Hormuz Strait to remain closed unless U.S. meets Iran's conditions, Iranian security council says - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-11 16:09

Iran's security council reiterated that the Strait of Hormuz stays closed without US concessions, keeping oil supply risk elevated.

5. Gulf shipping traffic via Strait of Hormuz falls to six vessels - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-11 04:44

Gulf shipping traffic through the Strait of Hormuz fell to just six vessels, signaling severe disruption to crude flows.

6. Oil hits new one-week high as supply disruptions outweigh Strait of Hormuz talks - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-11 00:38

Oil hit a one-week high as supply disruptions outweighed talks over the Strait of Hormuz, boosting energy prices.

7. Rupee retreats to near two-week low as US-Iran standoff pushes oil higher - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-11 02:59

The Indian rupee fell to a near two-week low as higher oil prices from the US-Iran standoff pressured the currency.

8. Gold eases from over two-month high as rising oil prices cloud rate outlook - reuters.com

Reuters — 2026-08-11 00:48

Gold eased from a two-month high as rising oil prices clouded the outlook for interest rate cuts, reducing bullion demand.

9. Gulf stocks fall on fading prospects of US-Iran deal - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-11 13:36

Gulf stock markets declined as fading prospects of a US-Iran deal weighed on investor sentiment in the region.

10. Wall Street ends down as expectations of Hormuz deal fade - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-10 23:19

Wall Street closed lower as expectations of a Hormuz deal faded, dragging equities amid geopolitical risk.

Market Snapshot

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
US Equities				
SPY	S&P 500 ETF	773.03	-0.03%	neutral
QQQ	Nasdaq 100 ETF	720.87	-0.30%	neutral
DIA	Dow Jones ETF	538.99	-0.12%	neutral
IWM	Russell 2000 ETF	299.98	-0.52%	bearish
XLK	Technology ETF	186.32	-0.88%	bearish
XLF	Financials ETF	57.81	+0.36%	neutral
US Treasuries				
SHY	2Y Treasury ETF	81.86	-0.07%	neutral
IEF	10Y Treasury ETF	92.76	-0.44%	neutral
TLT	20Y+ Treasury ETF	82.06	-0.85%	bearish

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
Credit				
LQD	Investment Grade Bond ETF	105.96	-0.55%	• bearish
HYG	High Yield Bond ETF	79.48	-0.16%	• neutral
Commodities				
GLD	Gold ETF	402.54	+1.02%	• bullish
SLV	Silver ETF	59.41	+3.32%	bullish
USO	Oil ETF	125.92	+6.73%	• bullish
UNG	Natural Gas ETF	10.14	+4.11%	• bullish
FX				
UUP	US Dollar Index ETF	28.14	+0.25%	neutral
FXE	Euro ETF	106.51	-0.16%	• neutral
FXJ	Japanese Yen ETF	57.62	-1.06%	• bearish
Crypto				
BTC-USD	Bitcoin	63910.59	-1.44%	bearish
ETH-USD	Ethereum	1871.28	-1.96%	bearish

Key Macro Indicators

Indicator	Value	As Of
Fed Funds Rate Target	3.5% – 3.75%	2026-08-11
10Y Breakeven Inflation (%)	2.27	2026-08-11
10Y-2Y Yield Spread (bp)	0.48	2026-08-11
VIX	15.46	2026-08-10
USD Index (Broad)	119.0649	2026-08-07

Major Anomalies

USO — Oil ETF +6.73%

Cause: Oil prices jumped sharply due to escalating Middle East tensions, including attacks in the Red Sea and Gulf, and doubts about a US-Iran deal, raising supply disruption fears.

Forward Impact: Oil prices are likely to remain elevated with geopolitical risk premium, but could retreat if diplomatic progress occurs or if supply disruptions are resolved.

UNG — Natural Gas ETF +4.11%

Cause: Natural gas prices rose significantly, likely driven by broader energy market strength and possibly weather-related demand or supply constraints, though no specific headline directly explains the move.

Forward Impact: Natural gas may see continued volatility depending on weather forecasts, storage levels, and any shifts in energy market sentiment.

SLV — Silver ETF +3.32%

Cause: Silver prices surged amid geopolitical tensions and safe-haven demand following Middle East conflicts and uncertainty over US-Iran relations.

Forward Impact: Silver may continue to be supported by geopolitical risks and potential Fed rate cuts, but could face volatility if tensions ease.

Macro Data Releases — Today

[Calendar error: 403 Client Error: Forbidden for url: <https://finnhub.io/api/v1/calendar/economic?from=2026-08-11&to=2026-08-19&token=d88f5hpr01qq4342ton0d88f5hpr01qq4342tong>]

Economic Calendar — Next 7 Days

No upcoming macro events in the next 7 days.

Sector Heat Map

Sector Performance Heatmap			
	1D	5D	1M
Energy	+4.7%	+2.4%	+9.3%
Healthcare	+1.7%	+3.8%	+4.7%
Materials	+0.6%	+4.2%	+4.5%
Financials	+0.4%	+0.8%	+3.8%
Consumer Discretionary	-0.2%	+1.2%	+2.1%
Industrials	-0.3%	+0.8%	+1.5%
Consumer Staples	-0.2%	+0.1%	+1.0%
Technology	-0.9%	+4.7%	+0.3%
Communication Services	+0.5%	+0.4%	+0.2%
Real Estate	-1.3%	-1.7%	-0.1%
Utilities	-1.1%	-2.8%	-5.0%

Hot Now

- **XLE** — Strong 1d, 5d, and 1m gains, indicating robust momentum.
- **XLV** — Consistent positive returns across all timeframes, with solid 5d and 1m performance.
- **XLB** — Positive 5d and 1m returns, showing steady accumulation.

Cold but Worth Watching

- **XLU** — Negative across all timeframes, but oversold conditions may attract value buyers.
- **XLRE** — Negative 5d and 1m, but 1d decline may be overdone, potential for bounce.

Momentum is favoring cyclical and defensive sectors like energy, healthcare, and materials, while utilities and real estate are lagging but may offer contrarian opportunities.

Daily Conclusion

Risk-off sentiment dominates as energy-led inflation fears from unresolved US-Iran tensions drive commodity spikes (SLV, USO, UNG) while defensive sectors (XLU, XLRE) weaken and equities retreat.

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